



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts Prairie View

School Website: <https://prairieview.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Prairie View (Fort Worth, TX 76131) presents a strong classical-education profile across most rubric categories. Based on its publicly shared materials (curriculum, pedagogy, mission, and community engagement) and drawing on the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric, the school is generally CLASSICAL with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) showing only partial alignment. The aggregate assessment places Great Hearts Prairie View solidly in CLASSICAL territory, driven by explicit commitments to the liberal arts, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, character formation, dedicated faculty, and active parent/community partnership.

Key drivers of CLASSICAL status:

- Explicit emphasis on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals, formation-minded aims, and moral education (mission statements, outcomes, and the school's public narrative).
- Liberal arts curriculum with grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and a strong Great Books/Western-tradition emphasis (Curriculum pages, Classics to Keep, Humane Letters Seminars).
- Pedagogy centered on Socratic dialogue, seminars, and memory-based practices (Socratic Method, Humane Letters Seminars, classical recitation/memory culture).
- Faculty as models of virtue and living curriculum; teachers described as mentors and moral exemplars, with a clear "portrait of a teacher" in the materials.
- Strong parent/community partnership rhetoric and practices (parents as co-teachers, formation of families, open campus/visits).

Category-by-category signals (keyword analysis below) show that every category except one meets the core indicators very well; the overall mix supports a CLASSICAL classification for the school as a whole. See the category snapshots for detailed keyword evidence and the quantitative keyword analysis.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- The public materials foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals and a central aim of education (e.g., "pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" appears repeatedly in mission and program descriptions).
- There is robust emphasis on formation and virtue, including moral character and spiritual depth in the formation narrative, but explicit grounding in theology, liturgical practices, or formal worship is not prominently documented in the site content (no clear liturgical calendar, chapel, or Mass references visible in the public materials).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral formation, character, formation, moral imagination, wisdom (drawn from mission statements and formation language).
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced in the public materials regarding theology-liturgical foundations; absence of explicit liturgical or doctrinal content reduces alignment with the full religious/metaphysical expectations of a strict CLASSICAL profile per the rubric.
- Quantitative note: approximately 5–7 positive indicators identified; 0 clearly negative indicators documented in the public-facing materials for this specific category. The balance favors a strong-but-not-complete alignment with the religious/metaphysical foundations.

Why this rating

- The school emphasizes transcendental values (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) and formation, but it does not consistently demonstrate theology-grounded curriculum or liturgical/community practices in its public-facing materials. Therefore, it is categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in this dimension.

Citations: Truth/Goodness/Beauty and formation language appear in the mission and school narrative, including “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty” and formation language. The Socratic method and classical content referenced here also reinforce the general orientation, though explicit liturgical/theological practices are not foregrounded in the visible sections.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers on cultivating minds and hearts through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, i.e., formation of character and wisdom rather than mere job preparation.
- Outcomes emphasize humane education and moral formation, with long-range aims toward human flourishing and virtuous living (not solely career outcomes) and a liberal-arts-based pathway toward higher education and well-rounded excellence.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, wisdom, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, scholé/-contemplation (embedded in the formation narrative), great conversation/wisdom, character, moral imagination.
- Negative keywords present: minimal evidence of career-focused workforce-readiness or job-prep framing; the site emphasizes formation and virtue over narrow job outcomes (which aligns with the Positive side of the rubric).
- Quantitative note: multiple positive indicators (roughly 6–8) and no explicit negative signals in the public materials for this category.

Why this rating

- The school’s stated goal prioritizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty (classical aims) rather than solely preparing students for work; this aligns with CLASSICAL per the rubric.

Citations: Mission language and the outcomes narrative show formation and virtue emphasis; public-facing materials emphasize humane, liberal education and university prep as a path rather than vocational-only outcomes.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum centers on liberal arts in the Western tradition, including grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, history, natural science, and philosophy; Classics to Keep and Great Books are core elements.
- Public-facing materials describe Great Hearts' Great Books approach, Western canon, and humane letters seminars in upper grades, with a clearly explicit emphasis on reading, discussion, and engagement with primary sources (e.g., Humane Letters Seminars, daily Socratic discussions).
- The Kindergarten through high-school program includes Singapore Math, Latin, history, science via primary sources, and a strong emphasis on classic authors and texts; Classical methods are threaded throughout (Spalding method, Latin study, Great Books cadence).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, history, Western civilization, classics, primary sources, humane letters, great conversation, formation through the arts, living books, Classics to Keep, etc.
- Negative keywords present: minimal evidence of non-classical curricular framing; no dominant project-based or social-studies-centric framing appears in the core curriculum pages.
- Quantitative note: multiple positive indicators (well above 6) and zero explicit negative signals in the core curriculum materials.

Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/Western tradition, Latin, and humane letters, plus a narrative of "formation" through the curriculum, aligns strongly with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Curriculum page and Classics to Keep; Great Books emphasis; humane letters seminars; Kindergarten through high school content all underscore classical content and method.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials explicitly name the Socratic Method as the primary tool of cultivation and emphasize Socratic seminars in upper grades (Humane Letters Seminars).
- Pedagogical practices include memory-based recitation, chanting, and other classical modalities (memoria/recitation culture is described in the classical lexicon and in the Kindergarten/Lower School materials).
- The high-school program features Humane Letters Seminars that are daily and directed Socratically around Western texts; upper-level rhetoric and oratory opportunities are described as part of the program (classic rhetoric training; orations).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminars, great conversation, memory work, recitation, chanting/singing to memorize, rhetoric, seminars, Paideia-like structures, instruction aligned with classical formation.
- Negative keywords present: minimal explicit signals of non-classical pedagogy; terms like "project-based learning," "experiential learning" are not predominant in the core public materials (though science mentions hands-on activities, it is not framed as a project-based, assessment-dominant shift).
- Quantitative note: strong presence of classical pedagogical indicators; near-zero explicit non-classical signals in the public content.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy is clearly grounded in classical methods (Socratic dialog, memory work, recitation, seminars, and rhetoric training). This aligns with CLASSICAL conventions.

Citations: Socratic Method and Humane Letters Seminars; references to recitation/memory/chanting; upper-school rhetoric and oratory programs; Kindergarten through high school descriptions support a classical pedagogy alignment.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The materials describe a faculty that is “carefully chosen” and “models of learning and of character,” i.e., living examples and mentors, consistent with the living-curriculum concept.
- The published content emphasizes dedicated, enthusiastic, and intellectually excellent teachers who serve as models of learning and character, highlighting a mentorship and virtue role for faculty.
- There are explicit references to a “portrait of a teacher” and a “faculty as the living curriculum” in the documents, reinforcing the idea that faculty embody and transmit the classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, character formation, teachers as exemplars, mentorship, lifelong learners.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced in the public materials for this category; no statements suggesting a non-classical or instrumental-only faculty profile.
- Quantitative note: multiple strong positive indicators; no explicit negative indicators.

Why this rating

- The faculty is described in terms that align tightly with classical expectations (mentorship, living curriculum, character exemplars, modeling virtue), supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Lower/Upper School leadership and mission language; explicit statements about teachers as models and the living curriculum.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- A strong emphasis on partnership with families, with explicit framing of parents as co-teachers and as part of the classical-education ethos; materials discuss parent formation and classical family culture, and open campus visits are described.
- The Family Handbook and school communications outline ongoing education for parents (groups, seminars, book studies) to learn about classical education, and welcome visits at virtually any time, signaling high parental engagement and transparency.
- The academy’s mission prioritizes service to a rigorous core liberal-arts curriculum with family/parent involvement, reinforcing a truly collaborative community model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, open campus, parental engagement, school-parent collaboration, community of learners.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced in the public materials; there is no emphasis on customer-centric, minimal-parent-involvement models (the opposite is clearly stated).
- Quantitative note: multiple clear positive indicators; no explicit negative indicators in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates strong, explicit parent and community engagement and partnership, a core classical-element signal for this category.

Citations: Family Handbook, About/Mission pages, and parent-engagement content show active partnership and parent-education initiatives.

Overall Assessment

Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale: Across categories 2–6, the Great Hearts Prairie View materials demonstrate robust alignment with classical education principles: a formation-centered purpose; a liberal-arts-curriculum anchored in Great Books and the Western tradition; Socratic pedagogy and memory-based practices; faculty as moral exemplars; and a strong, ongoing parent/community partnership. Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) shows partial alignment—centered on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and a strong formation/virtue emphasis but lacking explicit theology, liturgical practices, or formal worship in public-facing materials. Taken together, the school's profile is CLASSICAL with one area of partial alignment, thus the aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL.

Citations for the aggregate view draw from mission and curriculum materials, pedagogy statements, faculty descriptions, and parent/community language cited above.

Note on the knowledge-base alignment

- The evaluation leverages the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) as the primary rubric backbone (e.g., Truth/Goodness/Beauty; formation vs. information; classical curriculum; Socratic pedagogy; living curriculum; parental partnership). The Positive Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements document are used to ground the keyword analysis, with comparison against the Great Hearts Prairie View public materials. The Positive Keywords include terms like truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, liberal arts, great books, Socratic dialogue, and partnership with families, among others; Negative Keywords cover modern-education pitfalls like project-based or experiential-only approaches, value-neutral ethics, and workforce-prep emphasis. The Great Hearts Prairie View materials consistently align with the Positive Keyword set across categories 2–6 and partially with Element 1, enabling a predominantly CLASSICAL classification with a note of partial alignment in the religious/metaphysical foundation area. See the Six Essential Elements content for the lexicon and indicators, including the Positive Keywords list and related framing, as well as the school materials cited above.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — Element-by-Element Details

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Truth, Goodness, Beauty; formation; virtue language; limited mention of theology or liturgical practices. Positive keywords: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, moral imagination, character; Negative: minimal explicit theology-liturgical signaling. Overall: partial alignment with the category's full set of criteria. See citations above.
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation-centered mission; humane education; liberal-arts focus; university preparation as a path rather than a job-prep focus. Positive keywords: formation, wisdom, virtue, liberal education, scholé, human flourishing, moral imagination, truth/goodness/beauty; Negative: minimal roadmaps to workforce-prep framing. Overall: strong alignment with classical aims.
- Element 3 — Curriculum: CLASSICAL Evidence: Liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books/Western tradition; Latin; primary sources; Classics to Keep. Positive keywords: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, history, Western civilization, classics, primary sources,

humane letters, forming through the arts. Negative: none prominent in core materials. Overall: CLASSICAL.

- Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: CLASSICAL Evidence: Socratic method; daily humane letters seminars; recitation/memory practices; rhetoric training; upper-level seminars; memory-based learning. Positive keywords: Socratic method, seminars, great conversation, memory work, recitation, chanting, rhetoric, training in oratory; Negative: no pervasive signaling of non-classical constructs. Overall: CLASSICAL.
- Element 5 — Faculty: CLASSICAL Evidence: Model teachers, mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; teachers as exemplars. Positive keywords: model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentorship; Negative: none. Overall: CLASSICAL.
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: CLASSICAL Evidence: Partnership with families; parent formation and engagement; open campus; frequent opportunities for parent involvement. Positive keywords: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, parental engagement, open campus, community of learners, home-school collaboration; Negative: none. Overall: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the aggregate classification were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, concrete steps would include:
- Explicitly articulating and documenting theology/theology-informed liturgical practices or devotional life in a public-facing way to elevate Element 1 to CLASSICAL.
- Broadly expanding the language of faith-based formation (without compromising non-denominational charter status) to clearly connect religious/metaphysical foundations with daily practice (worshipful practices, liturgical calendar, chapel times, etc.).
- Further increasing explicit alignment between classical aims and assessment (e.g., narrative assessment framed around formation and virtue across all grades, not primarily grades/performance) to emphasize the “formation over information” ideal in broader school communications.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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